

SHOWCASE

ENFIELD RIFLED MUSKET

Adding grooves to a musket's bore, or replacing its smoothbore barrel with a rifled one, helped convert muskets into rifled weapons, or rifles. With the perfection of the expanding bullet (see pp.98–99), it became possible to issue rifles to all troops, not just to sharpshooters, because rifles could now be loaded as fast as muskets. The British Army adopted a key rifle in 1853. This gun—the Pattern 1853 Rifled Musket—remained in service until 1867.

**ENFIELD
RIFLED MUSKET**
Date 1853

Origin UK

Barrel 33in (83.8cm)

Caliber .57in (14.65mm)

▼ PATTERN 1853 RIFLED MUSKET

This rifled musket, produced by the Ordnance Factory at Enfield, London, was a highly successful weapon. In the hands of a competent infantryman, it was effective beyond its sighted distance (900yards/820m), and at 100yards (90m), the bullet could pass through a dozen ½-in (1.5-cm) planks. A soldier was expected to maintain a firing rate of three to four rounds per minute. For all its apparent simplicity, this rifled musket has a total of 56 parts.

Lock cover plate bears maker's name and insignia

Small of stock is gripped in hand

Socket fits over muzzle

◀ BAYONET

The socket bayonet, with its triangular-section blade, protruded almost 18in (46cm) beyond the muzzle. It alone required 44 separate manufacturing operations.

▼ CARTRIDGES

Cartridges were dipped in wax to lubricate the bore.

For loading, soldiers tore off the twisted end of the cartridge with their teeth, poured the powder into the barrel, and rammed the lubricated end, carrying the projectile, down the muzzle.

Rumors that cow or pig fat were used in the wax offended Hindu and Muslim soldiers because they were forbidden to eat beef or pork respectively; this is one suggested cause of the Indian Mutiny of 1857.

Triangular-section blade